

Data Platforms Buyers Guide

Software Provider and Product Assessment

**SOFTWARE
PROVIDER
REPORT**

***ISG** Research

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Key Takeaways – Data Platforms

Data platforms underpin the storage, processing and analysis of information that supports enterprise applications and digital interactions. Organizations rely on these platforms to manage operational workloads that run the business as well as analytic workloads used to evaluate performance and guide decisions. The expansion of cloud infrastructure, object storage and diverse data models has increased architectural diversity, resulting in enterprises deploying multiple platforms to support different workloads and application requirements.

Software Provider Summary

The ISG Buyers Guide™ for Data Platforms evaluates 23 software providers offering products supporting enterprise data storage, processing and analytics for operational and analytic workloads. The research ranked the top three overall leaders as Oracle, Databricks and AWS. Providers were classified using weighted performance in Product Experience and Customer Experience for ISG quadrant placement. AWS, Databricks, Google Cloud, IBM, InterSystems, Microsoft, Oracle, Progress Software and SAP were rated as Exemplary, with Alibaba Cloud, Cloudera and Snowflake rated as Innovative. Actian, Huawei Cloud and Salesforce were rated as Assurance; and Aiven, Broadcom, Couchbase, EDB, Neo4j, SingleStore, Tencent Cloud and VAST Data were rated as Merit.

Product Experience

Product Experience, representing 80% of the evaluation, focuses on Capability (50%) and Platform (30%), which includes adaptability, manageability, reliability and usability. Oracle, Databricks and InterSystems achieved the highest performance as Leaders in this category, supported by broad capabilities across data persistence, processing and artificial intelligence (AI) workloads and strong platform adaptability and governance for enterprise deployment. Leaders demonstrated enterprise-grade platform capabilities applicable across varied technical roles, operational contexts and analytic use cases.

Customer Experience Value

Customer Experience, representing 20% of the evaluation, focuses on validation and TCO/ROI. AWS, IBM and Oracle were the Leaders in this category, showing strong customer advocacy and clear investment in success outcomes. Providers with lower performance often lacked publicly available customer validation or failed to demonstrate structured ROI measurement and proactive lifecycle engagement.

Strategic Recommendations

Enterprises should evaluate data platforms based on their ability to support both operational and analytic workloads, particularly as AI-driven applications increasingly require real-time data processing and inference. Decision-makers should assess how well platforms integrate diverse data models, processing engines and governance capabilities across hybrid and cloud environments. Organizations should also consider operational factors such as deployment model, cost management and administrative overhead when evaluating managed cloud services versus self-managed platforms.



Data Platforms

It is no exaggeration to state that today's enterprises, and society as a whole, are completely dependent on data platforms. Without data platforms, complemented by data operations and data management tools, there would be no enterprise or consumer applications, no digital commerce and no AI. Data platforms underpin nearly every digital interaction and business process in modern organizations.



Enterprises deploy multiple platforms to support different data models, workloads and application requirements, reflecting the reality that no single approach is suitable for all use cases.

ISG Research defines data platforms as providing an environment for organizing and managing the storage, processing, analysis and presentation of data across an enterprise. Data platforms play a critical role in supporting operational applications that run the business as well as analytic applications that evaluate business performance.

Since the 1980s, the data platform market has been dominated by the relational data model and relational database management systems. However, relational systems have never been the only option. Non-relational data models that pre-date relational, including hierarchical models, remain in use today, while more recent decades have seen the proliferation of key-value, document and graph databases. Data processing frameworks and object storage have further expanded the range of available approaches. As a

result, enterprises rarely rely on a single data platform. Instead, they deploy multiple platforms to support different data models, workloads and application requirements, reflecting the reality that no single approach is suitable for all use cases.

Deployment models have also evolved. While data platforms were traditionally deployed on-premises, enterprises are increasingly deploying them on cloud infrastructure or consuming them as managed cloud services. More than one-half of participants in ISG's Market Lens Cloud Study report using cloud environments for the majority of their data platforms.

At the core of any data platform is the ability to store, manage and process collections of related data. This functionality is typically provided by database management systems and, increasingly, by object storage combined with query and processing engines. Cloud adoption has accelerated the use of object storage, enabling enterprises to manage large volumes of structured and unstructured data at scale, which is particularly important for modern analytics and AI use cases.

Beyond simple infrastructure changes, the shift to cloud has altered how enterprises consume and operate data platforms. Increasingly, organizations are adopting managed cloud data



services to reduce operational overhead, accelerate deployment and improve scalability. These services can simplify administration, patching and upgrades, but they also introduce new considerations around cost management, performance consistency and governance. As a result, deployment model decisions now carry strategic implications that extend beyond infrastructure choice to operating model and platform control.

A fundamental consideration when selecting a data platform is whether the primary workload is operational or analytic. Historically, the market has been segmented between operational data platforms that support applications running the business and analytic platforms used for reporting, business intelligence (BI), data science and AI. Operational workloads include finance, supply chain, human capital management, customer experience and marketing, while analytic workloads focus on evaluating and optimizing the business.

The increasing importance of intelligent, AI-driven operational applications is blurring the distinction between operational and analytic data platforms. Consumers and employees increasingly expect real-time, data-driven experiences differentiated by personalization and contextual recommendations. Supporting these applications requires data platforms that can deliver both transactional performance and analytic insight concurrently.

Traditionally, enterprises separated operational and analytic workloads by extracting, transforming and loading data from operational systems into analytic platforms. While this approach remains relevant, intelligent applications increasingly require real-time access to analytic processing. Data-driven enterprises continue to train models offline using specialized platforms, but operational data platforms must increasingly support real-time AI inferencing to deliver predictions, recommendations and automation. We assert that through 2028, data platform providers will prioritize the development of hybrid operational and analytic processing capabilities to meet the requirements of intelligent applications driven by agentic and generative AI (GenAI).

The popularization of GenAI has further expanded data platform requirements, particularly around storing and processing vector embeddings. These representations enable natural language processing (NLP) and recommendation systems and support retrieval-augmented generation (RAG), which combines retrieved, up-to-date data with model-generated responses to improve accuracy and trust. In enterprise environments where accuracy, recency and reliability are critical, RAG can reduce hallucinations and improve confidence in GenAI-driven outputs. While vector processing and retrieval capabilities have become table-stakes,

Data Platforms
Market Assertion

Through 2028, data platform providers will prioritize the development of hybrid operational and analytic processing functionality to meet the requirements of intelligent applications driven by agentic and generative AI.

Matt Aslett
Director of Research, Analytics and Data

ISG Research



providers continue to differentiate through indexing approaches, performance optimization and the ability to scale these capabilities across large, evolving data sets.

The Data Platforms Buyers Guide is designed to provide a holistic view of a software provider's ability to support both operational and analytic workloads. The evaluation considers whether providers deliver these capabilities through a single platform or a suite of integrated products or services. Providers focused exclusively on either analytic or operational workloads are covered in separate Buyers Guide research.

The 2026 ISG Buyers Guide™ for Data Platforms evaluates software providers across key capability areas including data persistence, data processing, data analytics, data administration, data development, data architecture, sovereign AI and data, AI agents and AI for data platforms. This research evaluates the following software providers: Actian, Aiven, Alibaba Cloud, AWS, Broadcom, Cloudera, Couchbase, Databricks, EDB, Google Cloud, Huawei Cloud, IBM, InterSystems, Microsoft, Neo4j, Oracle, Progress Software, Salesforce, SAP, SingleStore, Snowflake, Tencent Cloud and VAST Data.



The Findings – Data Platforms

The software providers and products evaluated in this research offer product and customer experiences, but not every feature is equally valuable to every enterprise or is needed to support the relevant business processes and use cases. Moreover, having too many product capabilities may be a negative factor for an enterprise if it introduces unnecessary complexity. Nonetheless, you may decide that a more comprehensive set of capabilities is important and meets your enterprise's requirements.

An effective customer relationship with a software provider is vital to the success of any investment. The overall customer experience and the full lifecycle of engagement play a key role in ensuring satisfaction and long-term success. Providers with dedicated customer leadership, such as chief customer officers, tend to invest more deeply in these relationships and prioritize customer outcomes in line with TCO and ROI expectations. It is equally important that this commitment to customer success is evident throughout the provider's website, the buying process and the customer journey.

Overall Scoring of Software Providers Across Categories

The research finds Oracle atop the list, followed by Databricks and AWS. Providers that place in the top three of a category earn the designation of Leader. Oracle has done so in five categories; Databricks in four; AWS in three; InterSystems in two; and IBM in one category.

The quadrant chart below presents ratings for Product Experience and Customer Experience on the x- and y-axes, respectively, to visually classify software providers. Those providers whose Product Experience has above-median weighted performance on the axis, in aggregate across the two product categories, place farther to the right. The performance and weighting for the Customer Experience category determine placement on the vertical axis. In short, software providers that place closer to the upper-right on this chart performed better than those closer to the lower-left.

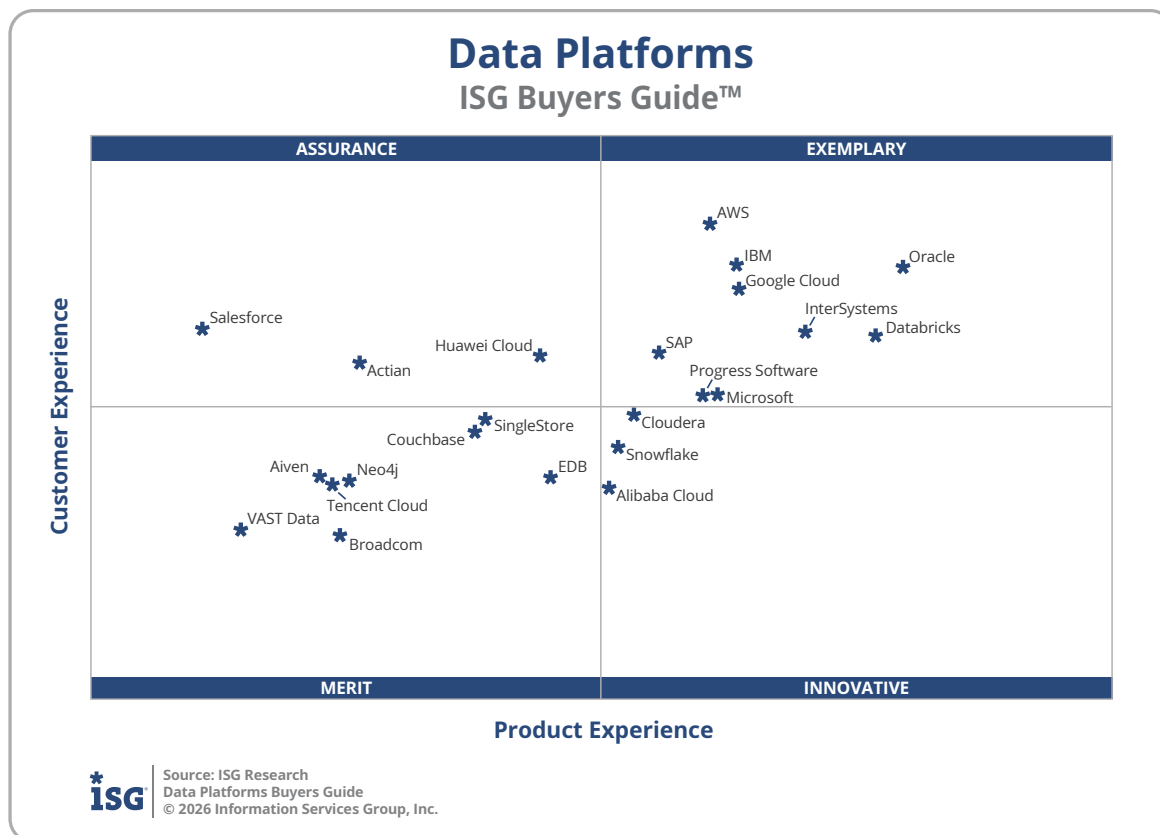
The research categorizes and rates software providers into one of four categories: Assurance, Exemplary, Merit or Innovative. Placement represents the software providers' weighted performance in meeting the requirements of product and customer experience.

Data Platforms Overall

Providers	Grade	Performance
Oracle	A	Leader 89.1%
Databricks	A	Leader 87.9%
AWS	A-	Leader 85.8%
InterSystems	A-	85.3%
IBM	A-	84.6%
Google Cloud	A-	83.6%
Microsoft	A-	82.3%
Progress Software	B++	80.9%
SAP	B++	80.7%
Cloudera	B++	78.9%
Snowflake	B++	78.6%
Huawei Cloud	B++	77.4%
Alibaba Cloud	B++	77.3%
Couchbase	B++	75.6%
Action	B++	75.3%
EDB	B++	75.1%
Tencent Cloud	B+	74.4%
Salesforce	B+	73.1%
SingleStore	B+	72.8%
Neo4j	B+	70.6%
Broadcom	B+	69.8%
Aiven	B	68.6%
VAST Data	B	66.5%



Source: ISG Research
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Exemplary: This rating (upper right) applies to those providers that performed above the median on Product and Customer Experience requirements. The providers rated Exemplary are: AWS, Databricks, Google Cloud, IBM, InterSystems, Microsoft, Oracle, Progress Software and SAP.

Innovative: This rating (lower right) applies to those that performed above median in Product Experience but not in Customer Experience. The providers rated Innovative are: Alibaba Cloud, Cloudera and Snowflake.

Assurance: This rating (upper left) applies to those that performed above median in Customer Experience but not in Product Experience. The providers rated Assurance are: Action, Huawei Cloud and Salesforce.

Merit: This rating (lower left) applies to those that did not surpass the median in Customer or Product Experience. The providers rated Merit are: Aiven, Broadcom, Couchbase, EDB, Neo4j, SingleStore, Tencent Cloud and VAST Data.

We advise enterprises to use this research as a supplement to their own evaluations, recognizing that ratings or rankings do not solely represent a provider's value nor indicate universal suitability of a set of products.



Product Experience

The process of researching products to address an enterprise's needs should be comprehensive, evaluating specific capabilities and the underlying platform of the product. Our evaluation of the Product Experience examines the lifecycle of onboarding, configuration, operations, usage and maintenance. Too often, provider assessments focus on market execution and future vision rather than the full product.

Product Experience accounted for 80% (four-fifths) of the rating based on the underlying weighted performance. The category weighting was 50% for Capability and 30% for Platform. Oracle, Databricks and InterSystems were designated Product Experience Leaders.

Data Platforms

Product Experience

Providers	Grade	Performance
Oracle	A	Leader 71.6%
Databricks	A	Leader 70.9%
InterSystems	A-	Leader 69.1%
Google Cloud	A-	67.4%
IBM	A-	67.3%
Microsoft	A-	66.8%
AWS	A-	66.6%
Progress Software	A-	66.4%
SAP	A-	65.3%
Cloudera	B++	64.6%
Snowflake	B++	64.2%
Alibaba Cloud	B++	64.0%
EDB	B++	62.4%
Huawei Cloud	B++	62.2%
Couchbase	B++	60.7%
SingleStore	B++	60.5%
Actian	B+	57.5%
Neo4j	B+	57.2%
Broadcom	B+	57.0%
Tencent Cloud	B+	56.8%
Aiven	B+	56.5%
VAST Data	B	54.4%
Salesforce	B	53.4%



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Capability of the Product

Capability criteria assess the products and features across a broad range of data platform capabilities that support AI agents, AI for AI and data platforms, data administration, data analysis, data architecture, data development, data persistence, data processing and sovereign AI and data.

ISG Research evaluated more than 160 different function points in nine sections to assess the full scope of data platform capabilities. The research weights Capability at 50% of the overall rating. Oracle, Databricks and InterSystems are the Leaders in this category. While not a Leader, Google Cloud was also found to meet a broad range of enterprise capability requirements.

The Capability evaluation for data platforms provides a framework for enterprises. Software providers with greater breadth and depth and that support the full set of needs fared better.

Data Platforms

Capability

Providers	Grade	Performance
Oracle	A	Leader 89.5%
Databricks	A-	Leader 86.9%
InterSystems	A-	Leader 86.8%
Google Cloud	A-	86.7%
Progress Software	A-	85.1%
IBM	A-	85.1%
SAP	A-	83.5%
Microsoft	A-	83.0%
Cloudera	A-	82.7%
SingleStore	A-	81.9%
EDB	A-	81.3%
AWS	B++	81.2%
Alibaba Cloud	B++	81.1%
Snowflake	B++	80.3%
Huawei Cloud	B++	80.0%
Couchbase	B++	76.5%
Aiven	B++	75.8%
Neo4j	B+	73.2%
Broadcom	B+	71.9%
VAST Data	B+	70.7%
Action	B	67.9%
Tencent Cloud	B-	62.1%
Salesforce	B-	60.0%



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Platform of the Product

The Platform category evaluates the underlying requirements of a platform and examines how well a software product meets enterprise needs across business and IT. It measures how effectively the product can be managed, configured and integrated into enterprise environments; how efficiently it can be governed and secured; how reliably it performs and scales; and how intuitively it supports users across varied roles and skill levels. The Platform category in the ISG Buyers Guide™ examines specific requirements for adaptability, manageability, reliability and usability.

The grading of the underlying platform focuses on a software product's overall robustness and the flexibility of a provider's software foundation. Adaptability measures a product's ability to be customized and integrated across systems and data, while manageability focuses on governance, security and compliance. Reliability considers performance and scalability across environments, and usability assesses how intuitive and accessible the product is through design, AI use and ongoing provider investment.

ISG Research evaluated 16 function points in five sections to assess the full scope of platform capabilities. The research weights Platform at 30% of the overall rating. Databricks, Oracle and AWS are the Leaders in this category.

Platform is an essential evaluation category as it indicates the strength and resilience of a software provider's product architecture. A well-designed platform ensures secure and compliant operations, dependable scalability and uptime, and a unified, intuitive experience for a range of usage personas. It also reflects the provider's capacity to support deployment models while maintaining flexibility to meet enterprise demands.

Software providers that performed best in the Platform category have support for the breadth and depth of needs across business and IT, supporting adaptability, manageability, reliability and usability. Providers with lower performance were challenged in one or more of these areas or did not demonstrate a cohesive, enterprise-grade approach. The underlying platform for a software provider's products is essential in any evaluation.

Data Platforms Platform

Providers	Grade	Performance
Databricks	A	Leader 91.4%
Oracle	A	Leader 89.5%
AWS	A-	Leader 86.7%
Tencent Cloud	A-	85.7%
InterSystems	A-	85.6%
Microsoft	A-	84.1%
IBM	A-	82.6%
Snowflake	B++	80.0%
Google Cloud	B++	80.0%
Progress Software	B++	79.6%
Action	B++	78.6%
SAP	B++	78.5%
Salesforce	B++	78.1%
Alibaba Cloud	B++	78.1%
Cloudera	B++	77.5%
Couchbase	B+	74.9%
Huawei Cloud	B+	74.0%
EDB	B+	72.6%
Broadcom	B+	70.0%
Neo4j	B	68.7%
SingleStore	B	65.1%
VAST Data	B	63.4%
Aiven	B-	62.0%



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Customer Experience

The importance of a customer relationship with a software provider is essential to the actual success of the products and technology. The evaluation of the Customer Experience and the entire lifecycle an enterprise has with its software provider is critical to ensuring satisfaction with that provider. The ISG Buyers Guide™ examines a software provider's customer commitment, viability, customer success, sales and onboarding, product roadmap and partner and support services. The customer experience category also examines TCO/ROI and how well a software provider demonstrates the product's overall value, costs and benefits, including the tools and resources to evaluate these factors.

The research results in Customer Experience account for 20% (one-fifth) of the full 100% index, and represent the underlying provider validation and TCO/ROI requirements as they relate to the framework of commitment and value to the software provider-customer relationship.

The software providers that ranked the highest in the Customer Experience category are AWS, IBM and Oracle. These category leaders best communicate commitment and dedication to customer needs.

Software providers that did not perform well in this category were unable to provide or make sufficient information readily available to demonstrate success or articulate their commitment to customer experience. The use of a software provider requires continuous investment, so a holistic evaluation must include examination of how they support their customer experience.

Data Platforms Customer Experience

Providers	Grade	Performance
AWS	A	Leader 18.2%
IBM	A	Leader 17.6%
Oracle	A	Leader 17.5%
Google Cloud	A-	17.2%
Salesforce	A-	16.6%
InterSystems	A-	16.5%
Databricks	A-	16.4%
SAP	B++	16.2%
Huawei Cloud	B++	16.1%
Action	B++	16.0%
Microsoft	B++	15.5%
Progress Software	B++	15.5%
Cloudera	B++	15.2%
Couchbase	B++	15.1%
SingleStore	B+	14.9%
Snowflake	B+	14.7%
EDB	B+	14.2%
Aiven	B+	14.2%
Neo4j	B+	14.1%
Tencent Cloud	B+	14.1%
Alibaba Cloud	B+	14.0%
VAST Data	B	13.3%
Broadcom	B	13.2%



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Software Provider Inclusion – Data Platforms

For inclusion in the ISG Buyers Guide™ for Data Platforms in 2026, a software provider must be in good standing financially and ethically, have at least \$75 million in annual or projected revenue verified using independent sources, sell products and provide support on at least two continents, and have at least 50 customers. The principal source of the relevant business unit's revenue must be software-related, and there must have been at least one major software release in the past 12 months.

To be included in the Data Platforms Buyers Guide, the product must be marketed as a general-purpose database, database management system, data warehouse, data lake, or data lakehouse and provide functionality that addresses these capabilities: data persistence, data processing, data analytics, data administration, data development, data architecture, sovereign data and AI, AI for data platforms.

The research is independent of the specifics of software provider packaging and pricing. To represent the real-world environment in which businesses operate, we include providers that offer suites or packages of products that may contain relevant individual modules or applications. If a software provider is actively marketing, selling and developing a product for the general market, and it is reflected on the provider's website that the product is within the scope of this research, we automatically evaluate that provider for inclusion.

We invited all software providers offering relevant products and meeting the inclusion requirements to participate in the evaluation process at no cost.

Software providers that meet our inclusion criteria but did not completely participate in our Buyers Guide were assessed solely on publicly available information. As this could significantly impact classification and ratings, we recommend additional scrutiny when evaluating those providers.



Products Evaluated

Provider	Product Names	Version	Release Month/Year
Actian	Actian Data Platform	630.0.59	October 2025
	Actian Ingres	12.1	February 2026
Aiven	Aiven for ClickHouse	December Release	December 2025
	Aiven for PostgreSQL	January Release	January 2026
Alibaba Cloud	Alibaba Cloud MaxCompute	January Release 2.0.18.1.2.0	January 2026
	Alibaba Cloud PolarDB for PostgreSQL		January 2026
AWS	Amazon Relational Database Service for PostgreSQL	18.1 patch 197	November 2025
	Amazon Redshift	1.0.194394	January 2026
Broadcom	VMware Tanzu for Postgres	18.1	November 2025
	VMware Tanzu Greenplum	7.7.0	December 2025
Cloudera	Cloudera Data Services	January Release	January 2026
	Cloudera Platform	January Release	January 2026
Couchbase	Couchbase Capella	December Release	December 2025
Databricks	Databricks Data Intelligence Platform	January Release	January 2026
EDB	EDB Postgres AI	2026.01.0	January 2026
Google Cloud	Google AlloyDB for PostgreSQL	January Release	January 2026
	Google BigQuery	January Release	January 2026
Huawei Cloud	Huawei Cloud Data Warehouse Service	April Release	April 2025
	Huawei Cloud RDS for PostgreSQL	August Release	August 2025
IBM	IBM Db2	12.1	January 2026
	IBM watsonx.data	2.3.0	December 2025
InterSystems	InterSystems IRIS	2025.3	November 2025
Microsoft	Microsoft Fabric	January Release	January 2026
Neo4j	Neo4j AuraDB	2025.11.0	December 2025
Oracle	Oracle Autonomous AI Database	January Release	January 2026
Progress Software	Progress Data Platform	1.4.0	January 2026



Salesforce	Salesforce Data 360	Winter '26	October 2025
SAP	SAP Business Data Cloud	January Release	January 2026
SingleStore	SingleStore Helios	December Release	December 2025
Snowflake	Snowflake Platform	10	January 2026
Tencent Cloud	Tencent Cloud TCHouse-C TencentDB for PostgreSQL	February Release June Release	February 2025 June 2025
VAST Data	VAST AI Operating System	5.4.0	November 2025



Providers of Promise

We did not include software providers that, as a result of our research and analysis, did not satisfy the criteria for inclusion in this Buyers Guide. These are listed below as “Providers of Promise.”

Provider	Product	Capability	Revenue	Geography	Customers
CelerData	CelerData	Yes	No	Yes	Yes
GridGain	Unified Real-Time Data Platform	Yes	No	Yes	Yes
Materialize	Materialize	Yes	No	Yes	Yes
SurrealDB	Surreal Cloud	Yes	No	Yes	Yes



Progress Software

Company and Product Profile

Progress Data Platform, v1.4.0, January 2026

"Progress Software empowers organizations to achieve transformational success in the face of disruptive change. The Progress Data Platform enables enterprise AI by unifying data, applying semantic context and enforcing governance, so AI systems can reason over trusted information and deliver accurate, explainable outcomes." — Progress Software

Summary

Our analysis classified Progress Software as Exemplary, receiving an overall grade of B++ with an 80.9% performance. Progress Software's best grouped results came in Product Experience with an 82.0% performance and an A- grade. In Customer Experience, Progress Software received a B++ grade with a 77.4% performance.

Strengths

Progress Software performed best in Product Experience, notably in Capability thanks to its data architecture, functionality to address data analysis and its delivery of AI for Data Platforms.

In Customer Experience, Progress Software performed well due to the strength of its product roadmap as well as its articulation of strategic value and customer commitment.

Challenges

The Customer Experience evaluation identified opportunities for improvement in the availability of tools that enable prospective customers to evaluate potential costs. In Product Experience, Progress Software could benefit from enhancing accessibility as well as customization and configuration features.

Data Platforms		
Progress Software		
Exemplary Provider		
Category	Performance	Grade
Overall	80.9%	B++
Product	82.0%	A-
Capability	85.1%	A-
Platform	79.6%	B++
Customer	77.4%	B++

 Source: ISG Research
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Buyers Guide Overview

ISG Research has conducted market research for over two decades across vertical industries, business applications, AI and IT. We have designed the ISG Buyers Guide™ to provide a balanced perspective on software providers and products, rooted in an understanding of business and IT requirements. Utilizing our research methodology and decades of experience, our Buyers Guide is an effective tool for assessing and selecting software providers and

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ISG Research has designed the Buyers Guide to provide a balanced perspective on software providers, rooted in an understanding of business and IT requirements.

products. The findings of this research provide a comprehensive approach to rating software providers and rank their ability to meet specific product and customer experience requirements.

This ISG Buyers Guide™ is the distillation of continuous market and product research. It is an assessment of how well software providers' offerings address enterprises' requirements. The Value Index methodology is structured to support a request for information (RFI) for a request for proposal (RFP) process by incorporating all criteria needed to evaluate, select, utilize and maintain relationships with software providers. The ISG Buyers Guide™ evaluates customer experience and the product experience across capability and platform.

The structure of the research reflects our understanding that the effective evaluation of software providers and products involves far more than just examining product features, potential revenue or customers generated from a provider's marketing and sales efforts. It can ensure the best long-term relationship and value achieved from a resource and financial investment. We believe it is important to take a comprehensive, research-based approach, since making the wrong choice of software can raise the total cost of ownership, lower the return on investment and hamper an enterprise's ability to reach its potential. In addition, this approach can reduce the project's development and deployment time and eliminate the risk of relying on opinions or historical biases.

ISG Research believes that an objective review of existing and potential new software providers and products is a critical strategy for the adoption and implementation of enterprise software. An enterprise's review should include an analysis of both what is possible and what is relevant. We urge enterprises to conduct a thorough evaluation, and we offer this ISG Buyers Guide™ as both the results of our in-depth analysis of these providers and as an evaluation methodology.



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About ISG

[ISG](#) (Nasdaq: [III](#)) is a global AI-centered technology research and advisory firm. A trusted partner to more than 900 clients, including 75 of the world's top 100 enterprises, ISG is a long-time leader in technology and business services that is now at the forefront of leveraging AI to help organizations achieve operational excellence and faster growth. The firm, founded in 2006, is known for its proprietary market data and research, in-depth knowledge and governance of provider ecosystems, and the expertise of its 1,500 professionals worldwide working together to help clients maximize the value of their technology investments.

About the Authors



David Menninger

Executive Director, Software Research and Distinguished Analyst

David Menninger leads the overall team for software research and advisory for supporting IT and expertise in AI software at ISG. With over three decades of experience in enterprise software, Dave's leadership has advanced digital transformation with information and insights for enterprises around the world.



Matt Aslett

Director of Research, Analytics and Data

Matt Aslett leads software research and advisory for Analytics and Data at ISG. His focus areas of expertise and market coverage include data platforms, data management, data operations and real-time data, as well as analytics and AI, with a focus on the data management requirements for AI use-cases, including generative and agentic AI.